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THE BTC CYCLE TOP CHECKLIST

The 8 indicators I actually watch, with the trigger thresholds
and what each one means without the jargon.

By Torin Christianson · LiftOffr.com

How to Use This Checklist

I run through this every Sunday before I write the brief. When **5 or more** of these 8 flash "TOP ZONE" at once, the cycle is statistically near its peak. No single indicator has ever been enough on its own for me — **confluence is what actually moves me to act.**

Print it. Check each indicator once a week, count how many are in the trigger zone, and match your score against the table on the last page.

1 CBBI (Colin Talks Crypto Bull-Bear Index)

WHAT IT IS: Composite score of 11 on-chain + market indicators, scaled 0–100.

TRIGGER ZONE: **85+** = top zone. **95+** = historical cycle top.

I trust this more than any other single number on the list. It called 2013, 2017, and 2021 within weeks of the actual top. October 2025 peaked at 94, just under the historical 95+ line — still deep enough in top territory that it did its job.

SOURCE: colintalkscrypto.com/cbbi/

2 Pi Cycle Top Indicator

WHAT IT IS: Crossover of the 111-day MA and 2× the 350-day MA.

TRIGGER ZONE: Cross within 3% = warning. Full cross = signal fired.

I like this one because it's binary — it either fires or it doesn't. It nailed 2013, 2017, and April 2021 within 3 days. It missed the November 2021 ATH and it missed my own October 2025 top call at \$124,824 entirely, which is exactly why I never trade off one indicator alone.

SOURCE: lookintobitcoin.com/charts/pi-cycle-top-indicator/

3 MVRV Z-Score

WHAT IT IS: Distance between BTC market cap and "realized" cap, normalized.

TRIGGER ZONE: 5+ = top zone. 7+ = extreme.

Same idea as CBBI, different math — how far price has run from what people actually paid for it. 2013, 2017, and 2021 all cleared 7. October 2025 hit top zone on lower raw values, which tells me institutional money is dampening the extremes a little, not killing the cycle.

SOURCE: lookintobitcoin.com/charts/mvrz-score/

4 Market Cipher B (Weekly)

WHAT IT IS: Custom oscillator combining money-flow, RSI, and divergence detection.

TRIGGER ZONE: Weekly bearish divergence with VWAP rejection.

This is the one I actually watch on my own charts, not just read about after the fact. A red dot at the top of the weekly range with bearish divergence is rare — when I see it, I pay attention.

SOURCE: TradingView (paid indicator).

5 BTC Rainbow Chart

WHAT IT IS: Logarithmic regression bands colored from blue (cheap) to red (overvalued).

TRIGGER ZONE: **Red zone** ("Maximum Bubble Territory") = sell signal.

Blunt but honest. If price is sitting in the red band, I'm taking some off the table regardless of what anything else says.

SOURCE: blockchaincenter.net/bitcoin-rainbow-chart/

6 2-Year Moving Average Multiplier

WHAT IT IS: BTC price vs. 2-year MA × 5.

TRIGGER ZONE: Price above the red line (5× 2Y MA) = top zone.

Slow and unglamorous, which is exactly why I like it — every prior cycle topped within months of price crossing that red line.

SOURCE: lookintobitcoin.com/charts/2-year-moving-average/

7 Crypto Fear & Greed Index

WHAT IT IS: Aggregated sentiment 0–100 based on volatility, momentum, social media.

TRIGGER ZONE: 90+ "Extreme Greed" sustained for 2+ weeks.

I don't act on this alone, ever — it's confirmation, not a trigger. But when it's pinned at 90+ for weeks, that's the market telling you it's euphoric, and euphoria doesn't last.

SOURCE: alternative.me/crypto/fear-and-greed-index/

8 Google Trends — "Bitcoin"

WHAT IT IS: Worldwide search interest for "Bitcoin," scaled 0–100.

TRIGGER ZONE: 80+ sustained = retail FOMO peak.

This is the "is your aunt asking about Bitcoin yet" test. It hit 100/100 at the 2017 and November 2021 peaks. October 2025 topped without it ever spiking — the first cycle I've seen do that, and part of why I lean on all 8 instead of picking a favorite.

SOURCE: trends.google.com/trends/explore?q=bitcoin

The Confluence Score

Count indicators in the trigger zone. Match your score:

Score	What It Means	Action
0–2	Mid-cycle	Accumulate / DCA

3–4	Late cycle warning	Tighten stops, plan exits
5+	TOP ZONE	Execute exit plan
7–8	Cycle top imminent	Full risk-off

Want the live scoring done for you?

Inside LiftOffr you get daily BTC briefs, weekly cycle dashboards with live scoring, real-time signals, and the full 6-module framework.

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